

FURMAN UNIVERSITY WOMEN IN BUSINESS CONSTITUTION AND BYLAWS

Created 2024

SECTION I

Name and Mission

ARTICLE I. Name.

This organization shall officially be known as Furman University Women in Business (FUWIB), chartered at Furman University in Greenville, South Carolina. This organization is a recognized organization at Furman University and adheres to all University policies as set forth in the Furman University Student Handbook.

ARTICLE II. Mission.

Furman University Women in Business (FUWIB) is an organization centered around uniting women with a passion for business. FUWIB's mission is to assist these women in developing their academic and career paths alongside other women with similar interests, forming a robust support system before they enter the professional field, which historically has been male-dominated.

ARTICLE III. Purpose.

The purpose of Furman University Women in Business is to provide greater opportunities for community building within the male-dominated major and field of business. To achieve this, Furman University Women in Business hosts events such as alumni panels, social gatherings, networking opportunities, lectures, and CLPs to connect undergraduate students across the curriculum and establish connections with older students, recent graduates, alumni, and female professionals in the community with well-established careers.

SECTION II

Membership

ARTICLE I. Eligibility.

All students of the Furman community are eligible to become a member of Furman University Women in Business. In keeping with Furman University's non-discrimination policies, membership shall be open to all undergraduate, day students. Our organization will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, handicap, age, sexual orientation, political affiliation, or religious affiliation.

ARTICLE II. Membership.

In keeping with Furman University's non-discrimination policies, membership shall be open to all undergraduate, day students. Our organization will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, handicap, age, sexual orientation, political affiliation, or religious affiliation.

Organizations may not address a member's violations of university policy via internal standards boards or other accountability mechanisms without prior approval of the Dean of Students Office. Conduct expectations unique to membership in the organization and that do not overlap or otherwise interfere with university authority may be addressed with the written approval of the AVP/Dean of Students or designee. Groups affiliated with national organizations that have established guidance and procedures over disciplinary matters, may follow the directive of those national organizations with regard to member conduct but must do so with written approval of university.

ARTICLE III. Good Standing.

Members of Furman University Women in Business have the ability to be placed on the status of good standing if they meet certain criteria:

- Members must attend a minimum of two meetings for which they are enrolled and present at Furman University, or
- Members can actively participate in planning, running, or organizing events as determined by the student leader(s).
- Members must join the Women in Business Club on SyncDin.

SECTION III

Meetings

ARTICLE I. Regular Meetings.

Regular meetings shall be held at least once a month during the school year, preferably at a regular time and place.

ARTICLE II. Special Meetings.

The student leader(s) or faculty advisers shall reserve the right to call a special meeting with prior notice of no less than two (2) days being given to each member preceding a proposed special meeting, which shall be defined as any meeting that falls outside of the regular meeting schedule.

ARTICLE III. Meeting Structure.

Meetings of Furman University Women in Business shall be conducted in accordance with the agenda prepared by the student leader(s) or faculty advisers.

SECTION IV

Voting

ARTICLE I. General Voting Procedure.

Unless otherwise specified, voting shall be by a general vote, i.e. by upraised hand, and the outcome will be determined by a simple majority of those present and in good standing. In the event of a tie, the student leader(s) shall cast the deciding vote.

SECTION V

Executive Board Offices and Duties

ARTICLE I. Executive Board Officers.

Furman University Women in Business shall annually elect member(s) to serve as the student leader(s). Officers for the next academic year are to be elected at the end of the spring semester and will serve until election in the following year. In addition, a Faculty Advisor will be appointed by the student leader(s). Members may not hold more than one office. Multiple members may not jointly hold an office.

ARTICLE II. Nomination.

At least one week prior to the scheduled election, Furman University Women in Business shall accept open nominations for the position(s). Nominations must be made by a member in good standing. All nominees must be in good standing within the organization.

ARTICLE III. Election and Installation of Officers and Positions.

Election shall be determined after free discussion from the floor of the members, followed by a simple majority vote of all members who are present. Each person shall serve a term of one (1) academic year or until their successor has been installed. There shall be no restrictions on the number of terms a member may serve in a particular office. Should a vacancy occur in any office throughout the year, it may be filled by a majority vote at any meeting.

ARTICLE IV. Term of Office.

Each elected office shall be held per academic year, with elections occurring in the month of February for the following year's student leader(s).

ARTICLE V. Duties of Officers:

- Student Leader(s). The student leader(s) shall preside at all meetings and shall guide the conduct of the affairs of Furman University Women in Business. The student leader(s) shall act as the voice of the society to the Business department. In all voting situations, the student leader(s) vote shall be used to decide a tie. The student leader(s) shall have the authority to delegate all duties not specified by Furman University Women in Business' Bylaws. The organization may elect more than one student leader, but a maximum of five will be allowed.
- President. The president will schedule and preside over regular club meetings, setting agendas and facilitating discussions. They will also maintain communication with the faculty advisor, officers, and members. They will oversee the day-to-day operations and activities of the club and ensure all members are working together effectively.
- Vice President. The Vice president will assist the President with administrative tasks as needed. They will also collaborate with community members to facilitate campus-wide events.
- Secretary. The secretary will record what is done at club meetings, including attendance, and keep accurate permanent minutes.
- Treasurer. Treasurer will maintain all budget and reporting duties. They will be responsible for determining costs of events and delivering payments.
- Communications Liaison/Publicity Officer. The Publicity Officer will produce and distribute materials applicable to club members, such as flyers about upcoming events, handouts pertaining to club information, and more.
- Faculty Advisor. The faculty advisor shall act in an advisory capacity and shall be the liaison officer between Furman University Women in Business and the Furman Department of Business. This organization may have more than one advisor.

SECTION VI

Committees

ARTICLE I. Appointment of Committees.

All committees shall be appointed by the student leader(s) as circumstances require. Each committee will have a committee Chair appointed by the student leader(s).

SECTION VII

Finances

ARTICLE I. Budget.

Before the last meeting of the academic year, a budget shall be passed for the following fiscal year, which extends from August through July. The budget must pass by an affirmative vote of three-fourths (3/4) of the members present. The budget must be presented at two successive

meetings and must be approved after the second reading. This budget must then be submitted to Furman.

ARTICLE II. Financial Policy.

The student leader(s) are given the power to authorize routine expenditures allowed in the budget. However, no leader, committee, or member of this society shall obligate the society financially without the consent of the organization on any special expense. There shall be no expenditures without the approval of the organization. Any unauthorized expenditure without proper consent is not guaranteed to be paid. Furthermore, any contract to be signed by any member, therefore binding the society, financially or otherwise, must come before, be read, and approved by the organization. Any debts incurred on the organization by a single member are the responsibility of said member, not the organization.

ARTICLE III. Reimbursements.

No reimbursement shall be made for any organization expenditures without appropriate proof of purchases delivered to the student leader(s).

SECTION VIII

Rules of Order

ARTICLE I. Conducting Business.

Business will be conducted during weekly meetings among the executive team, during which discussions about upcoming events will take place. Business can also take place through digital communication when more convenient.

ARTICLE II. Conflict Resolution.

If conflict arises, it will be first handled among the student leader(s). All executive members will rationally discuss their points of view. If resolution is not reached, the matter will be brought to the faculty advisor.

SECTION IX

Amendments

ARTICLE I. Regulations for Amendments.

These Furman University Women in Business Bylaws may be amended at any business meeting by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of present members of the organization. All amendments to the Policies shall be read two (2) times consecutively and voted upon after the second reading. All amendments must be submitted to the Student Government Association.

ARTICLE II. Review of Policies.

These society policies shall be reviewed annually by Furman University Women in Business and when necessary revised.